

AI Strategy and Transformation Exercises and Solutions

Executive and practitioner assessment package

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Purpose and scoring standard

These exercises test whether learners can convert ambition into accountable institutional decisions. Full credit requires assumptions, evidence, consequences and decision authority to be explicit.

Criterion	Weight
Decision quality	30%
Evidence and assumptions	25%
Governance and accountability	20%
Feasibility and sequencing	15%
Clarity	10%

Part I Exercises

Exercise 1 Mandate and outcome

A ministry proposes an AI assistant to improve agricultural extension. Write a one-sentence transformation thesis and identify the accountable benefit owner.

Required output: a concise decision artifact with evidence and ownership.

Response space

Exercise 2 Evidence classification

Classify mandate documents, user interviews, system logs, model benchmarks and vendor claims as primary, operational, experimental or asserted evidence.

Required output: a concise decision artifact with evidence and ownership.

Response space

Exercise 3 Readiness profile

Score governance, data, people, technology, finance and operations from 0 to 4. Explain why the lowest dimension matters more than the average.

Required output: a concise decision artifact with evidence and ownership.

Response space

Exercise 4 Use-case boundary

Define the decision, user, inputs, outputs, exclusions and escalation path for an AI-enabled census quality review.

Required output: a concise decision artifact with evidence and ownership.

Response space

Exercise 5 Simpler alternative

Compare an AI proposal with workflow redesign, rule-based validation and improved reporting.

Required output: a concise decision artifact with evidence and ownership.

Response space

Exercise 6 Portfolio scoring

Create weights for strategic value, feasibility, evidence confidence, urgency and learning value.

State two mandatory gates.

Required output: a concise decision artifact with evidence and ownership.

Response space

Exercise 7 Sensitivity analysis

Re-rank the portfolio after reducing data-readiness weight and increasing equity weight.

Required output: a concise decision artifact with evidence and ownership.

Response space

Exercise 8 Decision record

Draft a gate decision for a pilot with strong demand but incomplete data lineage.

Required output: a concise decision artifact with evidence and ownership.

Response space

Exercise 9 Operating model

Assign outcome, data, technical, risk and adoption ownership for one initiative.

Required output: a concise decision artifact with evidence and ownership.

Response space

Exercise 10 Roadmap dependencies

Sequence data definitions, access controls, prototype, field validation, training and deployment.

Required output: a concise decision artifact with evidence and ownership.

Response space

Exercise 11 Benefits register

Specify adoption, outcome, equity, cost and incident measures.

Required output: a concise decision artifact with evidence and ownership.

Response space

Exercise 12 Procurement control

Write five contract clauses that reduce vendor dependency.

Required output: a concise decision artifact with evidence and ownership.

Response space

Exercise 13 Uncertainty briefing

Translate a wide confidence interval into an executive recommendation.

Required output: a concise decision artifact with evidence and ownership.

Response space

Exercise 14 Case transfer

Use one consulting case in the lesson to identify a lesson that transfers to AI strategy without calling the historical assignment an AI deployment.

Required output: a concise decision artifact with evidence and ownership.

Response space

Exercise 15 Board decision memo

Prepare a 250-word recommendation: scale, redesign, defer or stop one initiative.

Required output: a concise decision artifact with evidence and ownership.

Response space

Part II Instructor solutions and marking guidance

Solution 1 Mandate and outcome

The thesis must link the assistant to a measurable extension decision, named beneficiaries and a time horizon. The benefit owner is the executive with authority over extension outcomes, not the technology supplier.

- Award full credit when the decision and owner are explicit.
- Reduce credit for untested assumptions presented as facts.
- Do not reward technical sophistication that bypasses a mandatory control.

Solution 2 Evidence classification

Mandates are primary institutional evidence; interviews are contextual evidence; logs are operational evidence; controlled benchmarks are experimental evidence; vendor claims remain asserted until independently verified.

- Award full credit when the decision and owner are explicit.
- Reduce credit for untested assumptions presented as facts.
- Do not reward technical sophistication that bypasses a mandatory control.

Solution 3 Readiness profile

A defensible answer documents every score. The weakest dimension can become a binding constraint; a high average cannot compensate for absent authority, unsafe data or no operational owner.

- Award full credit when the decision and owner are explicit.
- Reduce credit for untested assumptions presented as facts.
- Do not reward technical sophistication that bypasses a mandatory control.

Solution 4 Use-case boundary

The boundary should keep final acceptance with authorized census staff, exclude automatic correction of source records and route anomalies to documented human review.

- Award full credit when the decision and owner are explicit.
- Reduce credit for untested assumptions presented as facts.
- Do not reward technical sophistication that bypasses a mandatory control.

Solution 5 Simpler alternative

Choose AI only when it adds measurable value beyond simpler controls. The comparison must include cost, implementation time, evidence quality and operational burden.

- Award full credit when the decision and owner are explicit.
- Reduce credit for untested assumptions presented as facts.
- Do not reward technical sophistication that bypasses a mandatory control.

Solution 6 Portfolio scoring

Weights must sum to 100 percent. Privacy legality and accountable human oversight are suitable gates because a weighted benefit score must not cancel a failed safeguard.

- Award full credit when the decision and owner are explicit.
- Reduce credit for untested assumptions presented as facts.
- Do not reward technical sophistication that bypasses a mandatory control.

Solution 7 Sensitivity analysis

A robust recommendation remains near the top across plausible weights. A rank reversal signals a decision that depends on contested priorities and must be discussed explicitly.

- Award full credit when the decision and owner are explicit.
- Reduce credit for untested assumptions presented as facts.
- Do not reward technical sophistication that bypasses a mandatory control.

Solution 8 Decision record

A sound record normally authorizes only bounded discovery or remediation, names the lineage evidence required, assigns owners, sets a review date and prohibits production scale-up.

- Award full credit when the decision and owner are explicit.
- Reduce credit for untested assumptions presented as facts.
- Do not reward technical sophistication that bypasses a mandatory control.

Solution 9 Operating model

Each role must have decision rights and evidence obligations. Combining roles requires an explicit conflict-of-interest control and escalation route.

- Award full credit when the decision and owner are explicit.
- Reduce credit for untested assumptions presented as facts.

- Do not reward technical sophistication that bypasses a mandatory control.

Solution 10 Roadmap dependencies

Definitions and lawful access precede development; prototype precedes field validation; training precedes operational handover; deployment follows evidence and authorization gates.

- Award full credit when the decision and owner are explicit.
- Reduce credit for untested assumptions presented as facts.
- Do not reward technical sophistication that bypasses a mandatory control.

Solution 11 Benefits register

Measures need baselines, targets, frequency, source, accountable owner and action thresholds. Model accuracy alone is not a transformation benefit.

- Award full credit when the decision and owner are explicit.
- Reduce credit for untested assumptions presented as facts.
- Do not reward technical sophistication that bypasses a mandatory control.

Solution 12 Procurement control

Expected clauses cover data rights, interfaces, documentation, audit evidence, knowledge transfer, portability, security duties and exit support.

- Award full credit when the decision and owner are explicit.
- Reduce credit for untested assumptions presented as facts.
- Do not reward technical sophistication that bypasses a mandatory control.

Solution 13 Uncertainty briefing

State what remains unknown, whether the decision is reversible, the downside exposure, what evidence would reduce uncertainty and the conditions for stopping.

- Award full credit when the decision and owner are explicit.
- Reduce credit for untested assumptions presented as facts.
- Do not reward technical sophistication that bypasses a mandatory control.

Solution 14 Case transfer

The response should name the original institutional challenge and derive a present-day control, while clearly separating historical evidence from the proposed AI application.

- Award full credit when the decision and owner are explicit.

- Reduce credit for untested assumptions presented as facts.
- Do not reward technical sophistication that bypasses a mandatory control.

Solution 15 Board decision memo

The memo should state the decision, evidence, alternatives, residual risks, conditions, owner, next review date and stopping rule. Concision and accountability matter more than technical detail.

- Award full credit when the decision and owner are explicit.
- Reduce credit for untested assumptions presented as facts.
- Do not reward technical sophistication that bypasses a mandatory control.

Capstone marking grid

Performance	Description
Excellent	Evidence-backed decision; explicit authority, conditions and stopping rule.
Competent	Sound logic with minor gaps in evidence or ownership.
Developing	Useful ideas but weak decision framing or control design.
Insufficient	Technology description without accountable institutional decision.